London

Metropolitan Grand Lodge

Advice for the Delivery of Mentoring to Experienced Masons

1. INTRODUCTION

The delivery of Mentoring to experienced Freemasons requires a tailored approach that respects their knowledge while providing opportunities for their further growth and engagement within the Craft.

It is likely that the Lodge Mentor will be of a lesser seniority than the brother that needs to be mentored. As such, the Mentor needs to find a Personal Mentor who will engender the respect of the candidate and who has the knowledge and seniority to be able to guide and instruct them. If the Lodge does not have a member of this calibre then it is wise to look further afield; it is here that the VO may be able to help by suggesting a suitable mason.

The following paragraphs provide a brief outline of the things that the Personal Mentor assigned to an experienced mason can do to Engage and enthuse them to progress further in the Craft. A more detailed approach can be found in the **Personal Mentoring Guide** and **Personal Mentoring Plan** which are available on Rosetta and Metmentor.com.

2. UNDERSTAND THEIR BACKGROUND AND EXPERIENCE

- Begin by discussing the candidate's Masonic journey – degrees, offices and honours held, their areas of expertise and their involvement in Metropolitan Grand Lodge activities.
- If they maintain a Masonic CV then ask if they would provide you with a copy.
- Assess their Masonic knowledge in terms of its history, its rules and constitutions and how it functions as an organisation. Unless the candidate has been a Secretary for a length of time, the Personal Mentor may well find that knowledge and understanding of the latter two areas could be quite limited.
- Establish what they hope to achieve or learn at their current stage in Masonry. Assist the candidate to identify goals that will help them to achieve their future aims.
- The Personal Mentor should always acknowledge the candidates contributions to the Craft thus far and show a genuine appreciation for their experience and wisdom.

3. FOSTER A MUTAL RESPECT

- At this level of seniority, the mentoring relationship should be conducted as a collaborative partnership rather than a hierarchical dynamic.
- The candidate will be far from ignorant of the ways of the Craft but will need friendly guidance and discussion in order to give them a

- framework for their existing knowledge and the new information they will receive.
- The candidate's appreciation of the mentoring process can be enhanced by encouraging them to share their knowledge with newer members and perhaps becoming a Personal Mentor in their own right.

4. INTRODUCE NEW PERSPECTIVES

- If the candidate has an interest in the deeper esoteric teachings of the Craft, offer them opportunities and resources to explore advanced Masonic philosophy, symbolism, or history.
- Encourage the candidate to become involved in Inter-Lodge Activities in order to expand their horizons beyond their own mother Lodge.
- Suggest that the candidate joins either the Kent or Connaught club as appropriate to their age. This will provide the candidate with further opportunities to extend their Masonic network.
- If they have been through the Chair then suggest they join a Past Masters Lodge to improve their Masonic network. The Personal Mentor should facilitate this by acting as their Proposer or by getting an acquaintance to Propose them.
- If they show interest then suggest that they become involved in MetGL or Grand Lodge initiatives to further broaden their exposure. The Personal Mentor should facilitate this by providing the candidate with useful contacts
- Highlight how Masonic principles apply to contemporary challenges in the world as a whole.

5. ENCOURAGE LEADERSHIP AND SERVICE

- Encourage the candidate to take on a mentoring role themselves and by sharing their insights with newer Masons gain a better appreciation of masonry as a whole.
- Suggest the candidate takes up leadership roles in charitable or community-focused Lodge initiatives thereby gaining a deeper appreciation of what it is to be a mason.
- If the candidate has the skills to perform ritual, encourage them to become more involved in the Ritual by perfecting and performing rituals not only for their own Lodge but to help other Lodges with their ceremonies. This sets an excellent example to the younger brethren that the Ritual is far more meaningful when delivered in a well rehearsed manner from memory.

6. PROVIDE GROWTH OPPORTUNITIES

- There is a range of roles that the candidate can undertake that will not only benefit their own development but of those around them. Recommend that they participate in specialized Lodge committees or educational sessions.
- If applicable to the candidate, discuss joining additional Masonic bodies or pursuing higher degrees. Be careful that the candidate does not overload themselves with commitments that they will find difficult to satisfy – this might cause them to consider resigning.
- Suggest to the candidate that they look at delivering lectures or talks; there are many Masonic lectures on the web that they can choose from. The candidate might even consider researching and writing their own papers on Masonic topics.

7. CREATE A SUPPORTIVE ENVIRONMENT

- Maintain regular contact with the candidate but not so often that it becomes intrusive. Consistent communication will ensure the candidate feels valued and supported.
- Always be available to answer questions and to discuss issues with the candidate. If the candidate has found it necessary to contact you then the topic is of immediate concern to them and needs to be addressed.
- Ensure that the candidate is publicly acknowledged for their efforts during Lodge meetings or Lodge events. This might include a gentle round of applause after a well delivered section of Ritual or a request to the Secretary that the candidate's efforts should be recorded.

8. ENCOURAGE REFLECTION AND RENEWAL

- Encourage the candidate to revisit the degrees with a focus on new interpretations or overlooked details.
- Encourage the candidate to reflect on how Masonry continues to shape their character and values and also how they would like to develop in the future.
- Explore with the candidate how they might leave a lasting impact on the Lodge or the fraternity in general.

9. CONCLUSION

By respecting the candidates experience and by inspiring them with new challenges, you can keep their journey in Masonry meaningful and fulfilling.